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Cheat sheet

1. Basic Linux Commands

Command	Description	Sample usage
pwd	Show current directory	pwd
ls	List files in a folder	ls -la
cd	Change directory	cd Documents
mkdir	Create a new folder	mkdir project
rm	Delete a file or folder	rm -r old_folder
cp	Copy a file	cp a.txt b.txt
mv	Move or rename a file	mv a.txt notes.txt
cat	Show file content	cat readme.md
touch	Create an empty file	touch index.html
chmod	Change file permissions	chmod +x script.sh
grep	Search text inside files	grep "error" log.txt
man	Show manual/help for a command	man ls

Command	Description (own words)	Common option
git init	Starts tracking a folder as a Git project (creates the hidden .git folder).	-q (quiet)
git status	Shows which files are changed, staged, or untracked right now.	-s (short format)
git add	Moves changed files from working directory to the staging area.	-A (add all changes)
git commit	Saves the staged changes into the project's history.	-m "message"
git log	Lists the commit history of the project.	--oneline
git diff	Shows the exact line-by-line changes not yet staged.	--staged
git restore	Undoes changes in a file, bringing it back to the last commit.	--staged (unstage)
git branch	Lists, creates, or deletes branches.	-d (delete branch)
git checkout / switch	Moves to a different branch or commit.	-b (create + switch)
git merge	Combines changes from another branch into the current one.	--no-ff
git tag	Marks a specific commit as important (e.g. a version).	-a (annotated tag)
git clone	Copies a remote repository to your own computer.	--depth 1 (shallow clone)

3. The Three-Tree Architecture of Git

Git manages a project using three areas, or "trees":

- 1. Working Directory** — the actual files you see and edit on your computer.
- 2. Staging Area (Index)** — a holding area for changes you plan to commit next, filled using git add.
- 3. Repository (.git)** — the permanent history of all saved commits, created using git commit.

Flow: Working Directory → (git add) → Staging Area → (git commit) → Repository.

References

Git. (n.d.). Git documentation. <https://git-scm.com/doc>

GitHub Docs. (n.d.). Quickstart for GitHub Pages. <https://docs.github.com/en/pages/quickstart>

AI Usage Declaration

The author used Claude to help organize and lay out the content of this cheat sheet during assignment preparation. The author reviewed and edited the content as needed and takes full responsibility for the final content of the work.